

AI Use in This Course

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AI is used as part of my **instructional toolchain** in this course, including ideation, drafting, formatting, documentation, slides, quizzes, and grading assistance (comments only; all final decisions are human).

I make a **good-faith effort to review materials for accuracy and clarity**, but mistakes will still occur. When they do, they are **my responsibility as the instructor**. If you notice an issue, please contact me and I will address it.

You are **encouraged to use AI as a learning aid**, not as a replacement for thinking or skill development. I cannot (and will not) police moment-to-moment AI usage, so it is your responsibility to ensure that your workflow supports **active learning**.

Suggested approach:

- Try the work **without AI first**
- When stuck, use AI *or me* for hints and guidance
- After finishing, use AI to **check your work against requirements**

Building some coding “muscle memory” without constant assistance is important. It helps you develop confidence and judgment, especially when reviewing or integrating larger AI-generated contributions later. Vibe-coding can get you started, but **strong fundamentals turn a rusty moped into a rocket ship**.

Final Note

I understand that some students have a **strongly negative view of AI and of people who use it**. I get that — and I am personally somewhat torn as well.

In my judgment, AI will be an **integral part of the work of most future computer scientists**. Because of that, I am intentionally experimenting with both good and bad ways to use it, and attempting to model what I believe is **responsible AI usage**. That view is evolving and will continue to change.

If you dislike AI, I hope its integration into this course is not overly frustrating. With the possible exception of one or two assignments, **no AI is required to be successful in this class**. The core content and skills are fundamentally the same as what would have been taught in a similar course **40 years ago**.